

Lesson 17 Practice: Hardware, Software and Firmware

JKSSB Computer Awareness

October 10, 2026

Provenance: All 25 questions are original exam-pattern questions (*[Original]* plus the *[JKSSB FAA-pattern]*, *[JKPSI-pattern]*, *[SSC CGL-pattern]*, and *[JKSSB-pattern]* extension items, including MSQs); none reproduces an official paper item. Questions 5, 6, and 10 train the real Junior Assistant 2026 concept for hardware-versus-system-software classification (the concept recorded as PYQ-06, device driver = software; OS = system software) but are freshly written.

Q1. *[Original]* Expand OS.

- A. Operating System
- B. Open Source
- C. Output Setting
- D. Object Store

Q2. *[Original]* Expand BIOS.

- A. Binary Input Output Setup
- B. Basic Input Output System
- C. Basic Internal Operating System
- D. Boot Input Output Source

Q3. *[Original]* Which of the following is **hardware**?

- A. MS Word
- B. A printer driver
- C. The CPU
- D. Windows operating system

Q4. *[Original]* Which of the following is **software**?

- A. Keyboard
- B. Monitor
- C. MS Word
- D. CPU

Q5. *[Original]* A device driver is best classified as:

- A. hardware

- B. software
- C. firmware
- D. humanware

Q6. *[Original]* The operating system is an example of:

- A. application software
- B. system software
- C. hardware
- D. firmware

Q7. *[Original]* Firmware is best described as:

- A. a physical circuit inside the processor
- B. software stored in non-volatile memory inside a hardware device
- C. an application program for editing documents
- D. a person who operates the computer

Q8. *[Original]* Which of the following is normally stored in non-volatile memory such as ROM or flash and is used to start a device?

- A. Firmware
- B. RAM
- C. A document file
- D. A user account

Q9. *[Original]* **Humanware** refers to:

- A. the physical parts of the computer
- B. the programs stored on disk
- C. the people who use and operate the computer system
- D. the startup code in ROM

Q10. *[Original]* Which statement is **NOT** correct?

- A. A device driver is a hardware component.
- B. The operating system is system software.
- C. Firmware is stored in non-volatile memory.
- D. Humanware is the people component of a system.

Q11. *[Original]* Which pairing is correctly matched?

- A. Hardware — MS Word
- B. Software — keyboard
- C. Firmware — BIOS
- D. Humanware — CPU

Q12. *[Original]* Arrange the computing stack from the bottom (lowest) to the top (highest).

- A. Application, operating system, device driver, firmware, hardware
- B. Hardware, firmware, device driver, operating system, application
- C. Hardware, application, operating system, firmware, device driver
- D. Firmware, hardware, operating system, device driver, application

Q13. *[Original]* Evaluate the statements:

- I. A device driver is a software component.
- II. The operating system is system software.
- III. Firmware is stored on the hardware in non-volatile memory.

- A. I only
- B. I and II only
- C. II and III only
- D. I, II, and III

Q14. *[Original]* Which layer lets the operating system communicate with a specific hardware device?

- A. The application software
- B. The device driver
- C. The humanware
- D. The BIOS

Q15. *[Original]* Which of the following is an example of **application software**?

- A. The operating system
- B. MS Word
- C. The BIOS
- D. A printer driver

Q16. *[Original]* Which of the following is an example of **system software**?

- A. MS Excel
- B. The operating system
- C. A computer game
- D. A photo editor

Q17. *[Original]* Firmware is usually stored in:

- A. RAM
- B. ROM or flash memory
- C. the CPU registers
- D. a user folder on the hard disk

Q18. *[Original]* Which of the following is **NOT** a type of hardware?

- A. Motherboard
- B. Printer
- C. Device driver
- D. Keyboard

Q19. *[Original]* The human component of a computer system — the users, programmers, and administrators — is called:

- A. hardware
- B. software
- C. firmware
- D. humanware

Q20. *[Original]* A printer driver is needed because it:

- A. is the physical printer component
- B. lets the operating system communicate with the printer
- C. is the printer's firmware
- D. permanently stores the printed document

Q21. *[JKSSB FAA-pattern]* Which of the following is hardware?

- A. Keyboard
- B. MS Word
- C. Antivirus program
- D. Spreadsheet formula

Q22. *[JKPSI-pattern]* Firmware differs from ordinary software because it is:

- A. stored in non-volatile chips and tied to hardware.
- B. always typed fresh by the user.
- C. only heard through speakers.
- D. printed on paper before use.

Q23. *[SSC CGL-pattern]* A device driver is an example of:

- A. system software.
- B. an input device.
- C. an output device.
- D. a storage disk.

Q24. *[JKSSB-pattern]* (**MSQ: select ALL correct options.**) Which of the following are hardware?

- A. Monitor

- B. Hard disk
 - C. Operating system
 - D. Printer
- Q25.** *[SSC CGL-pattern]* (MSQ: select ALL correct options.) Which statements about hardware, software, and firmware are correct?
- A. Hardware refers to physical components.
 - B. Software refers to programs and instructions.
 - C. Firmware is software embedded for hardware control.
 - D. A device driver is a hardware component.
- Q26.** *[Original]* Which term describes the physical components of a computer?
- A. Hardware
 - B. Software
 - C. Firmware
 - D. Data
- Q27.** *[PYQ-adapted: JKSSB FAA 2024, QCRIAS item 668; SRC-16/SRC-19]* Firmware is typically stored in which kind of memory?
- A. Volatile RAM only
 - B. Non-volatile memory such as ROM/flash
 - C. CPU cache only
 - D. A printer buffer only
- Q28.** *[Original]* A device driver is best classified as:
- A. Software that helps the operating system communicate with hardware
 - B. A physical input device
 - C. A storage medium
 - D. A type of CPU register
- Q29.** *[Original]* Which is an example of application software?
- A. Word processor
 - B. Device driver
 - C. Boot firmware
 - D. Memory controller hardware
- Q30.** *[Original, MSQ drill]* (MSQ: select ALL correct options.) Which statements correctly classify components?
- A. A keyboard is hardware.
 - B. A device driver is software.
 - C. Firmware is low-level software associated with hardware control.
 - D. A spreadsheet file is a CPU register.